

Progressive influence and desire for generational change drive Tuesday's Democratic primaries

送信者: EG US Daily 受信日時: 2026-08-12 00:16

【要点】

- ・ウィスコンシン州、ミネソタ州、コネチカット州での民主党予備選は、進歩派イデオロギーと世代交代の動きが党内でどの程度の影響力を持つかを示す重要なテストとなる。
- ・ミネソタ州上院予備選では進歩派のペギー・フラナガン副知事が穏健派のアンジー・クレイグ下院議員と対戦し、進歩主義の強さを測る指標となっている。
- ・コネチカット州第1地区の予備選は、世代交代というテーマをより直接的に反映しており、現職のジョン・ラーソン議員が相対的な若さを訴える前ハートフォード市長ルーク・ブロニンと対戦している。
- ・ウィスコンシン州知事選では民主社会主義者のフランチェスカ・ホンが民主党候補として確実視されており、2028年の選挙に向けて揺れ動く州における進歩派候補の選挙可能性についての論争を形成する重要な競争となるだろう。
- ・トランプ大統領の関税脅威によってアメリカとカナダの交渉が進展し、8月19日の期限前に関税を回避する限定的な貿易協定が見通せる状況となっている。

【メール原文】

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Limited Canada trade deal would unlock USMCA talks

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Polysilicon 232 tariffs trade higher solar costs for US reshoring

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The "Sell America" trade is overblown even as modest dollar weakness is possible

Progressive influence and desire for generational change drive Tuesday's Democratic primaries. Today's primaries in Wisconsin, Minnesota, and Connecticut, coming near the tail end of the primary calendar,

will be yet another indication of the strength of the winds of change, both ideological and generational, buffeting the Democratic Party.

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The Minnesota Senate primary pits the progressive Lieutenant Governor Peggy Flanagan against the moderate Rep. Angie Craig (D-MN), with no clear favorite between them. The general election is very likely safe for Democrats, but the primary is notable for offering a purer test of the strength of progressive ideology—not just anti-establishment feeling—in the party than was the Michigan primary last week. Flanagan, the progressive, is in most respects the more establishment-aligned candidate, having been endorsed by the state Democratic party and Senator Tina Smith (D-MN).

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The primary in Connecticut's 1st district is also worth watching, with Rep. John Larson (D-CT) seeking a fifteenth term against former Hartford mayor Luke Bronin, who won the state party endorsement. Whereas Minnesota is a test of progressivism's strength, this primary is much more a test of the generational-change narrative in the party: The campaign itself has been mostly non-ideological, with Bronin instead having made his relative youth his primary campaign message.

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The Wisconsin gubernatorial primary looks to be a done deal, with Democratic Socialists of America member Francesca Hong the nearly certain Democratic nominee. If Hong is the nominee, this will—like the Michigan Senate race—be an important contest in shaping the pre-2028 narrative about the electability of progressives in swing states (see Michigan race will shape Democrats' 2028 primary narrative , 4 August 2026).

Limited Canada trade deal would unlock USMCA talks. President Donald Trump's Section 338 tariff threat has unlocked US-Canada negotiations, with a limited trade deal now in view that would prevent their imposition before the 19 August deadline (70% probability).

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Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney is now likely prepared to accept a limited deal—linking the rollback of Ottawa's retaliatory measures as well as marginal dairy concessions to reductions in US Section 232 tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminum—as a stepping stone to more comprehensive United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) and defense negotiations.

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Failure to make sufficient progress in ongoing talks would result in Section 338 tariffs being imposed on schedule, which would lead both sides to pull back and push any potential trade deal further into the future.

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For more, please see Limited trade deal would unlock USMCA talks , 11 August 2026.

Polysilicon 232 tariffs trade higher solar costs for US reshoring. On 6 August, the US announced that it will impose product-specific minimum import prices on polysilicon and solar products, plus a 15% tariff on select downstream products, effective 4 December 2026. The tariffs currently stack with existing tariffs and are capped at 15% for Japan, South Korea, EU, Taiwan, Switzerland, Liechtenstein, and 10% for the United Kingdom.

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With Chinese overcapacity pushing polysilicon prices well below Western production costs, the combination of price floor and tariffs is designed to reset US pricing. Investment-linked waivers that could be released in the four months before implementation, meanwhile, incentivize domestic capacity. Expect new manufacturing commitments and an import surge ahead of the 4 December effective date.

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The biggest pressure point is the mid-supply chain. The US has roughly 70 GW of module assembly but only 3-3.2 GW of cell capacity, leaving manufacturers reliant on imported wafers and cells. Tariffing these inputs will raise costs in the near term – especially for firms still using the 45X manufacturing credit – but should accelerate upstream integration. Southeast Asian and Indian exporters face the greatest exposure. South Korea could be relatively advantaged as its tariff ceiling and price floor narrow the price gap with lower-cost Asian competitors.

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The policy trades higher near-term costs for building out deeper domestic supply chains; spillover to semiconductors is likely to be more limited. US solar prices are already well above global levels, so taxing imported upstream inputs will add pressure even as domestic module manufacturing expands.

The “Sell America” trade is overblown even as modest dollar weakness is possible. (see 2026 Top Risks report, Red Herring: Sell America). The dollar has softened since the Fed meeting in late July, but it remains strong and flat year-to-date, with the moves tracking near-term Fed pricing closely and looking more tactical than structural.

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The strategic negatives are real, but they’re too small to turn the dollar. Tariff refunds are only small drag. Fiscal concerns are not going away, but they are global, not US-specific, and gold’s recent rise has been modest.

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Europe and China offer no alternative. Europe’s new power crisis, driven by nuclear problems and higher gas prices, and China’s weak growth cap how far the dollar falls. Monetary policy in key emerging markets is shifting to prioritize growth over inflation, seeking to slow currency appreciation and arguing against a sustained dollar decline.

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Flows do not support the structural story. Non-US investors have increased purchases of US equities in recent months. The softness owes more to outflows picking up than to buyers walking away.

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Moderate dollar weakness into year-end is plausible, but nothing resembling the H1/2025 1% fall. Longer term, persistent upward pressure on yields is likely as defense, strategic hedging and demographics compete with AI investment for capital.

Quote of the Day

“They’re mad that Daddy cut them off, and now they’re trying to get back at Daddy by throwing a hissy fit before the midterms in an effort to get him to notice them and their outbursts.” – Laura Loomer, quoted by Politico, referring to Tucker Carlson, Majorie Taylor Green, and other Republicans who have broken with President Trump. Carlson and Green are rumored presidential candidates in 2028; Carlson recently released a ten-point manifesto outlining the contours of a potential third-party bid for the White House.

On the Radar

27 July – 28 August: House on recess

10 August – 14 September: Senate on recess

19 August: Section 338 tariffs on Canada go into effect

1 September: Massachusetts primaries

9-10 September: GOP midterms convention

30 September: Government funding runs out

3 November: National midterm elections

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